GROUP DISCUSSION

# Group Discussion Tips & Frameworks

*Frameworks, Etiquette & Discussion Dynamics*

## 1. What Evaluators Look For in a GD

- Content & Subject Knowledge: Fact-based arguments over emotional rhetoric.
- Communication Clarity: Articulate delivery, moderate pace, and active listening.
- Leadership & Team Spirit: Facilitating quieter participants and moving the group toward consensus.
- Emotional Stability: Maintaining composure and diplomacy when challenged.

## 2. Structured Thinking Frameworks

- PESTLE Framework: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental dimensions.
- 360-Degree Perspective: Individual -> Society -> National -> Global viewpoint.
- Pros & Cons Matrix: Acknowledge valid counter-arguments before defending your thesis.
- Stakeholder Analysis: Examine impacts on consumers, businesses, government, and marginalized communities.

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*Opening, Steering & Handling Common Scenarios*

## 3. Initiation & Conclusion Strategies

- Initiating the GD: Only initiate if you understand the topic thoroughly; provide a clear definition and scope.
- Example Opener: 'Good morning everyone. Today we are deliberating on... I would like to outline three key dimensions...'
- Summarizing: A summary must remain unbiased, capturing all viewpoints, not just your personal stance.

## 4. Navigating Difficult GD Situations

- The Fish Market Scenario: Remain calm; wait for a momentary lull, raise your hand politely, and say: 'Friends, let us ensure everyone gets an opportunity to share their thoughts.'
- If you lack knowledge on an abstract topic: Listen actively to the first 2 speakers, extract key themes, and expand on them thoughtfully.
- Body Language: Sit upright, make eye contact with all participants (never the moderator), and nod encouragingly.